ZERO TRUST ACCESS DESIGN CLINIC — PROCTOR ONLY

ZTA Proctor Grading Guide

Grade each team's use-case solution and place it at a level — **Associate**, **Professional** or **Expert** — based on the depth of their answer. Aligned to the official Solution Guide. Full reference answers are in the **ZTA Proctor Guide**. **Do not show participants.**

The three levels

Associate 60–74

Foundational understanding. Identifies the right general Cisco products and meets the basic customer requirement, but is light on *how* features work and *why* Cisco is differentiated. Few edge cases.

Professional 75–89

Solid, correct design. Maps the pain points to the right Cisco products with a clear how and why, cites at least one Cisco differentiator, and the diagram marks enforcement points and meets the requirements.

Expert 90–100

Comprehensive and differentiated. Maps every pain point and requirement precisely, explains how each product works and why it beats competitors (multiple differentiators), and the diagram traces flows end-to-end with policy detail and integration.

Below Associate = Developing (< 60): incomplete or largely incorrect — missing core products or misunderstands the requirement.

How to grade

1. Read the team's three answer areas — **pain→product mapping**, **products (how & why)**, and the **diagram** — against the official reference answer in the Proctor Guide.
2. For each of the three criteria, decide the **level** (Associate / Professional / Expert) using the rubric below, then assign **points** within that band.
3. Sum the three criteria to a **/100** score; the total maps to the team's **level** for that use case (bands below).
4. Write **feedback**: at least one thing the team did well and one concrete improvement. Be specific and name products.
5. Award **partial credit generously** where intent matches the reference; reward genuine **Cisco differentiators**.
6. Repeat per use case. The team's **overall level** = the average of their submitted use-case scores (the three **required** cases must be attempted for a valid level; **bonus** cases can raise it).

Rubric — criteria × level (applies to every use case)

CRITERION	MAX	ASSOCIATE	PROFESSIONAL	EXPERT
Pain-point → product mapping	40	**20–27** Maps the main pain points to broadly correct products; some gaps or generic choices.	**28–34** Maps all pain points to the correct Cisco products, each with a clear reason.	**35–40** Every pain mapped precisely to the optimal product with strong justification; no gaps.
Products — how & why / differentiators	30	**15–20** Names products; explains "how" only partially; few or no differentiators.	**21–26** Correct "how" for each product and a real "why"; at least one Cisco differentiator.	**27–30** Precise "how" + compelling "why" for every product; multiple Cisco differentiators vs competitors.
Diagram & overall solution	30	**15–20** Diagram present and legible; labels groups; enforcement points partial or unclear.	**21–26** Labels groups, marks enforcement points; solution coherent and meets the requirements.	**27–30** Traces flow(s) end-to-end with policy/matrix detail; considers integration/edge cases; within budget.

Overall level by score (per use case, out of 100)

LEVEL	SCORE	MEANING
DEVELOPING	< 60	Incomplete or largely incorrect — missing core products or misunderstands the requirement.
ASSOCIATE	60–74	Foundational: right general products, meets the basic requirement; light on how/why.
PROFESSIONAL	75–89	Solid, correct design: pains mapped with clear how/why and a Cisco differentiator; enforcement points shown.
EXPERT	90–100	Comprehensive & differentiated: every pain/requirement mapped precisely, multiple differentiators, flows traced end-to-end.

Use Case 1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation

Required | 100 pts

Segment campus & branch wired/wireless clients into groups (Employees, IOT, deskagents, Guest) and control what each can reach. Pains: VLAN/subnet complexity, labour-intensive profiling, failing PCI, PCs behind on AV/OS, no budget for more firewalls.

Expected answer by level

LEVEL	WHAT A SOLUTION AT THIS LEVEL CONTAINS
ASSOCIATE	Chooses Cisco **ISE** and **SGTs** over VLANs/subnets and assigns the four groups (Employees, IOT, deskagents, Guest). Shows the basic intent to restrict IoT and Guest. Light on how the SGT matrix is built; may omit ISE Posture (AV/OS) or the PCI L7 nuance.
PROFESSIONAL	Maps every pain to the right product: **ISE profiling** (onboarding), **SGTs/SGACL** enforced on the existing switches (no new firewalls), **ISE Posture** for AV/OS remediation, and **FTD/FW inserted only where L7** is needed for PCI. Defines correct SGT-matrix rules (IoT → DC+Internet only; Guest → Internet only; Mac-mini → on-prem DC only) and cites a Cisco differentiator (SGACL more efficient / topology-independent). Diagram marks enforcement points.
EXPERT	All of Professional, plus an end-to-end story: **pxGrid / Rapid Threat Containment**, **Cisco Secure Workload** App Dependency Mapping for DC app segmentation, dynamic vs static SGT assignment and **ISE cloud-AI profiling**, and integration across switches/routers/FTD/SD-WAN. Diagram traces at least one flow end-to-end (e.g. IoT → DC permit, IoT → Employees deny) and inserts FTD only where L7/PCI requires it. Clearly argues why Cisco (end-to-end SGT, RFC8600 pxGrid) beats competitors.

Score

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	○ A ○ P ○ E	/ 40
Products — how & why	○ A ○ P ○ E	/ 30
Diagram & overall solution	○ A ○ P ○ E	/ 30
Total & level	○ Developing ○ Associate ○ Professional ○ Expert	/ 100

Feedback

✓ What the team did well

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 2 — Remote Workers — Zero Trust Access

Required · 100 pts

SASE for remote workers & branches. Requirements: ZTNA for modern apps (VPN only for legacy), block gambling/gaming, contractors clientless RDP, minimal sign-ons, SASE branches. Pains: over-permissive VPN, manual daily VPN, too many sign-ons, kill passwords, Okta too costly, reduce branch cost.

Expected answer by level

LEVEL	WHAT A SOLUTION AT THIS LEVEL CONTAINS
ASSOCIATE	Recognizes ZTNA over full VPN and proposes **Cisco Secure Access** with the **Secure Client ZTA module**; mentions SSO and blocking gambling/gaming. Light on how per-app tunnels, Duo Passport, passwordless, or SASE integration actually work.
PROFESSIONAL	Maps pains correctly: **ZTA module** (per-app, least-privilege) for modern apps with full VPN kept only for legacy; **SWG** to block gambling/gaming; **browser-only clientless** access for contractors; **Duo Passport SSO + advanced passwordless**; **Duo Directory** to replace costly Okta; **SD-WAN into Secure Access** for SASE. Explains why ZTNA beats full VPN.
EXPERT	All of Professional with the full Secure Access story and Cisco-unique points: **Private Resources proxy** (publish apps to VPN/ZTA/browser), **VPNaaS mapping VPN traffic to SGTs** for segmentation (unique to Cisco), **Unified Policy** for public+private resources, and **SD-WAN → Secure Access via IPsec + Direct Internet Access**. Diagram shows the SSE enforcement plane and per-user paths (employee/contractor/guest) with identity via Duo. Argues why Duo Passport/passwordless and Cisco SASE win over Okta/competitors.

Score

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	____ / 40
Products — how & why	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	____ / 30
Diagram & overall solution	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	____ / 30
Total & level	◯ Developing ◯ Associate ◯ Professional ◯ Expert	____ / 100

Feedback

✓ What the team did well

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 3 — AI Access and Agent Controls

Required | 100 pts

Report and guardrail AI usage from Use Case 2. Requirements: fine-grained tool control, corporate ChatGPT tenant only, control Claude Desktop agents, govern MCP servers (Claude Code). Pains: shadow AI, unknown/over-privileged MCP servers, personal ChatGPT credentials, risky model downloads.

Expected answer by level

LEVEL	WHAT A SOLUTION AT THIS LEVEL CONTAINS
ASSOCIATE	Understands the shadow-AI risk and proposes **Secure Access AI Access** for visibility/control; mentions restricting ChatGPT to the corporate tenant. Light on MCP-server governance, agent registration, or model inspection.
PROFESSIONAL	Maps pains: **Secure Access AI Access** (discover/control), **AI Gateway** to register/manage allowed MCP servers, **tenant controls** to force the corporate ChatGPT tenant and block personal logins, and **semantic inspection** to block risky models. Adds **Duo IdP** for fine-grained authorization and control of Claude Desktop agents.
EXPERT	All of Professional plus agentic depth: **Duo IdP agent registration (DCR)** governing what registered desktop agents and MCP integrations (Claude Code) may do, **DLP via Secure Access + Cisco AI Defense** to stop sensitive-data exposure across endpoint/cloud/web, and a clear per-identity fine-grained policy model. Argues why Cisco's AI Gateway + Duo integration is easier and more complete than IdP-only competitors.

Score

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	○ A ○ P ○ E	___ / 40
Products — how & why	○ A ○ P ○ E	___ / 30
Diagram & overall solution	○ A ○ P ○ E	___ / 30
Total & level	○ Developing ○ Associate ○ Professional ○ Expert	___ / 100

Feedback

✓ What the team did well

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 4 — Merger & Acquisition — Extend Segmentation

Bonus | 100 pts

Integrate a ~100-staff acquisition fast. Remote site has Cisco FTD (Internet edge + AI-cluster segmenting); acquired co uses Okta. Requirements: extend TrustSec segmentation, only selected users reach Site 9951. Pains: how to extend segmentation, don't want to onboard 100 users, minimize auth disruption, breached/passwords.

Expected answer by level

LEVEL	WHAT A SOLUTION AT THIS LEVEL CONTAINS
ASSOCIATE	Proposes extending **TrustSec/SGTs** to the acquired site and using **Duo** for the acquired users; basic idea to restrict Site 9951. Light on inline SGT tagging over the S2S VPN, SCIM import, or SSO routing.
PROFESSIONAL	Maps pains: **inline SGT tagging on the remote FTD over a site-to-site VPN** to extend segmentation from HQ; **source/destination SGTs** in the FTD policy to restrict Site 9951 to selected users; **Duo Directory + SCIM import from Okta** (no bulk corporate-directory onboarding); **Duo SSO routing** so Okta keeps working during transition; **Duo passwordless** for the breached users.
EXPERT	All of Professional plus **SCC pushing SGT policy into SD-WAN** (match source branch SGT to destination acquisition FTD), a clean migration path off Okta, and the Cisco differentiators of inline SGT tagging + Duo's easy multi-IdP integration. Diagram shows the S2S tunnel, extended SGTs, the restricted Site 9951 flow, and Duo directory/SSO federation.

Score

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	/ 40
Products — how & why	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	/ 30
Diagram & overall solution	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	/ 30
Total & level	◯ Developing ◯ Associate ◯ Professional ◯ Expert	/ 100

Feedback

✓ What the team did well

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 5 — Zero Trust across Multicloud Data Center

Bonus | 100 pts

Application sprawl across on-prem/AWS/Azure; discover apps (incl. Kubernetes), minimize blast radius, app run-time protection. Requirements: limited budget/native features/virtual appliances, end-to-end segmentation, minimize complexity. Pains: no app visibility, no segmentation plan, K8s latency/visibility, can't patch IoT, too many disparate consoles.

Expected answer by level

LEVEL	WHAT A SOLUTION AT THIS LEVEL CONTAINS
ASSOCIATE	Proposes **Cisco Secure Workload** to discover and segment applications across on-prem/AWS/Azure and mentions minimizing blast radius. Light on Kubernetes runtime, auto-baseline policy, or unified management.
PROFESSIONAL	Maps pains: **Secure Workload App Dependency Mapping** for visibility and **auto-baseline microsegmentation** (discover → validate → enforce); **Isovalent (Cilium/eBPF, Tetragon)** for Kubernetes observability and runtime protection; **Cisco Cloud Control (SCC)** to unify the many management interfaces; leverages native cloud features and **FTDv virtual appliances** for budget.
EXPERT	All of Professional plus the end-to-end policy story: **ISE common policy sharing identity/SGT context via pxGrid** to Secure Workload and FTD; **CSW ↔ FTDv policy sync**; kernel-level protection via **eBPF** as the runtime differentiator; and a coherent multicloud enforcement design that minimizes complexity and blast radius. Argues why Cisco's CSW+FTD+Isovalent integration beats native-only or point tools.

Score

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	☐ / 40
Products — how & why	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	☐ / 30
Diagram & overall solution	◯ A ◯ P ◯ E	☐ / 30
Total & level	◯ Developing ◯ Associate ◯ Professional ◯ Expert	☐ / 100

Feedback

✓ What the team did well

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▲ Where they can improve

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Team summary

Enter each use-case score, total the required cases (add bonus if attempted), and place the team at an overall level.

USE CASE	TRACK	SCORE /100	LEVEL
UC1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation	Required		◯ A ◯ P ◯ E
UC2 — Remote Workers — Zero Trust Access	Required		◯ A ◯ P ◯ E
UC3 — AI Access and Agent Controls	Required		◯ A ◯ P ◯ E
UC4 — Merger & Acquisition — Extend Segmentation	Bonus		◯ A ◯ P ◯ E
UC5 — Zero Trust across Multicloud Data Center	Bonus		◯ A ◯ P ◯ E
Overall	Required 1–3 (+ bonus)	avg	◯ Developing ◯ Associate ◯ Professional ◯ Expert

Overall feedback for the team

✓ Strengths

▲ Development areas

Proctor: ____________________ · Team: ____________________ · Date: ____________